

6 MCP Servers Every Claude Code User Needs

Install these once. Claude gains access to your meetings, research, docs, inbox, and video generation.

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What this is

MCP servers are connectors that give Claude Code access to external tools and services. Instead of switching between apps, you ask Claude directly and it pulls the data, writes to your docs, or generates visuals for you. The 6 servers below cover the tools most people already use every day.

Step 01

Set up Claude Code

Claude Code is Anthropic's terminal-based AI agent. You add MCP servers to it using the `claude mcp add` command. Each server runs a one-time authentication flow the first time you connect.

WHAT YOU NEED

1. Claude Code installed in your terminal (code.claude.com).
2. A Claude Pro or Max account.
3. Accounts for each tool you want to connect (Granola, Notion, Gmail, etc.).

Pro tip: Run `/mcp` inside Claude Code at any time to see which servers are connected and to authenticate new ones.

Step 02

Install the 6 MCP servers

Run each command in your terminal. Most take under 60 seconds. Each server asks you to authenticate via a browser window the first time.

1. Granola

Gives Claude access to every word from your meetings. Pull notes, action items, and content angles directly from your calls.

INSTALL COMMAND

```
claude mcp add granola --transport http https://mcp.granola.ai/mcp
```

Official MCP. Open a new terminal tab, run claude again, then type `/mcp` and select Authenticate.

2. NotebookLM

Lets Claude query your research, playbooks, and reference docs before writing anything. No more copy-pasting sources.

INSTALL COMMAND

```
Add to ~/.claude/claude_desktop_config.json: { mcpServers: { notebooklm: { command: npx,
args: [notebooklm-mcp@latest] } } }
```

Community MCP by PleasePrompto (github.com/PleasePrompto/notebooklm-mcp). Requires one-time Google browser login.

3. Notion

Reads and writes to your databases, calendars, and docs directly. No copy-paste between tools.

INSTALL COMMAND

```
claude mcp add notion --transport http https://mcp.notion.com/mcp
```

Official MCP by Notion. Authenticate via the OAuth flow using /mcp after install.

4. Gmail

Lets Claude sort through your inbox, draft replies, and pull tasks straight from your emails.

INSTALL COMMAND

```
claude mcp add gmail -- npx @dev-hitesh-gupta/gmail-mcp-server
```

Community MCP. Requires a one-time Google Cloud Console OAuth setup (about 5 minutes). Full guide: github.com/ihiteshgupta/gmail-mcp-server

5. Gemini

Connects Claude to Google's image generation models so you can generate infographics and visuals from inside Claude Code.

INSTALL COMMAND

```
claude mcp add gemini -s user -- env GEMINI_API_KEY=YOUR_KEY npx -y @rlabs-inc/gemini-mcp
```

Community MCP by RLabs. Get your free API key at aistudio.google.com/apikey.

6. Higgsfield

Lets Claude render cinematic videos from a single prompt, right inside the terminal.

INSTALL COMMAND

```
claude mcp add --transport http --scope user higgsfield https://mcp.higgsfield.ai/mcp
```

Official MCP. Sign in with your Higgsfield account when prompted. Requires an active Higgsfield subscription.

Step 03

Start using them in Claude Code

Once connected, you talk to your tools in plain language inside Claude Code. Type /mcp to see which servers are active, then start asking.

EXAMPLE PROMPTS TO TRY

Granola

```
Search my Granola meetings for any action items from the last 2 weeks and list them.
```

NotebookLM

Open my NotebookLM notebook called [YOUR NOTEBOOK NAME] and summarise the key points.

Notion

Find my Notion database called [YOUR DATABASE] and show me all tasks marked In Progress.

Gmail

Search my Gmail inbox for emails from [SENDER NAME] in the last 7 days and summarise them.

Gemini

Generate an infographic about [YOUR TOPIC] and save it to my desktop.

Higgsfield

Create a cinematic video of [YOUR SCENE DESCRIPTION] using Higgsfield.

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